UNIX Text Editors

To write a program or a paper even to edit a mail message, you need to create, write,store, retrieve, view, and edit files. In unix several text editors available for this .

Editors available unix are **ed, node,NEdit, emacs and vi** .

One of the first end-user programs hosted on the system and standardized in UNIX-based systems ever since is the vi editor. ed is a line editor for the UNIX operating system.

vi Editor:

vi (pronounced "vee-eye") is short for "vi"sual editor. It is a visual editor used to create and edit text files.

It displays a window into the file being edited that shows 24 lines of text. vi lets you add, change and delete text, but does not provide formatting capabilities like centering lines or indenting paragraphs.

vi works in three different modes:

1. Edit Mode -where any key is entered as text
2. Command Mode -where keys are used as commands
3. Ex Mode -ex commands can be entered in last line to act on text

Invoking vi with/without filename puts it in command mode:

vi []

Commands to be used in vi:

For cursor movement within the vi editor, we can not use the mouse . We have to use key commands. To use a key command, user has to be in the command mode. To go to command mode, press the Esc key.

Commands to Enter and Exit vi:

command	Purpose of the command
vi filename	edit filename starting at line 1

vi –r filename	recover filename that was being edited when system crashed

The new or modified file is saved when user exits from vi. But it is also possible to exit without saving the file.

To use a command to exit from vi , after pressing the Esc key ,colon : is to be pressed.

The cursor moves to bottom of screen whenever a colon (:) is typed. This type of command is completed by hitting the (or) key.

command	Purpose of the command
:wq	quit vi, writing out modified file to file named in original invocation
:q	quit (or exit) vi
:q!	quit vi even though latest changes have not been saved for this vi call
:w	write current contents to file named in original vi call

Commands to insert or add text:

Following are the commands to be used to insert or add text.

key	Purpose of the command
u	Undo the last command's action
i	insert text before the cursor,until is hit
I	insert text at beginning of current line, until hit
a	append text after cursor, until hit

A	append text to end of current line, until hit
o	open and put text in a new line below current line, until hit
O	open and put text in a new line above current line, until hit

Commands to modify texts:

key	**Purpose of the command**
r	replace single character under cursor (no needed)
R	replace characters, starting with current cursor position, until hit
cw	change the current word with new text, starting with the character under cursor, until hit
cNw	change N words beginning with character under cursor, until hit; e.g., c5w changes 5 words
C	change (replace) the characters in the current line, until hit
cc	change (replace) the entire current line, stopping when is hit
Ncc or cNc	change *(*replace) the next N lines, starting with the current line, stopping when is hit

Commands to Delete texts:

key	**Purpose of the command**
x	delete single character under cursor
Nx	delete N characters, starting with character under cursor
cw	delete the single word beginning with character under cursor

dw	change N words beginning with character under cursor, until hit; e.g., c5w changes 5 words
dNw	delete N words beginning with character under cursor; e.g., d5w deletes 5 words
D	delete the remainder of the line, starting with current cursor position
dd	delete entire current line
Ndd or dNd	delete N lines, beginning with the current line; e.g., 5dd deletes 5 lines

Commands to copy and paste text:

yy	copy (yank, cut) the current line into the buffer
Nyy	copy (yank, cut) the next N lines, including the current line, into the buffer
p	put (paste) the line(s) in the buffer into the text after the current line

Commands for searching text

/string	search forward for occurrence of string in text
?string	search backward for occurrence of string in text